

PEER SUPPORT CAREER PATHWAY

Turn lived experience into purposeful work supporting others.

Kentucky peer support credentials changed in 2026.

The credential you need depends on the population you support and the type of organization where you work. Always confirm current requirements before enrolling in training.

YOUR PATH INTO PEER SUPPORT

1

CHOOSE YOUR DIRECTION

Adult, family, youth, mental health, substance use, or co-occurring peer support.

2

CHECK ELIGIBILITY

Kentucky peer roles are built around relevant lived experience and state credential requirements.

3

COMPLETE APPROVED TRAINING

Use a Kentucky-approved training provider for the credential that fits your intended role.

4

COMPLETE TESTING + CREDENTIALING

Submit required documentation and complete any testing, registration or certification steps.

5

FIND THE RIGHT WORK SETTING

Explore recovery community organizations, hospitals, clinics, treatment programs, justice settings and community agencies.

6

KEEP GROWING

Use supervision, continuing education and added credentials to expand your opportunities.

IMPORTANT KENTUCKY CREDENTIAL NOTE

Beginning January 1, 2026:

- Certified Peer Support Specialist (CPSS) roles apply in many non-AODE/non-BHSO settings.
- Registered Alcohol & Drug Peer Support Specialist (RADPSS) is required for Medicaid-billable SUD peer services in AODE/BHSO settings.



For current rules and the state decision guide: chfs.ky.gov

SKILLS THAT HELP PEERS SUCCEED

Active listening

Healthy boundaries

Documentation

Resource navigation

Information verified September 2, 2026. Source: Kentucky CHFS / DBHDID peer support credentialing guidance.